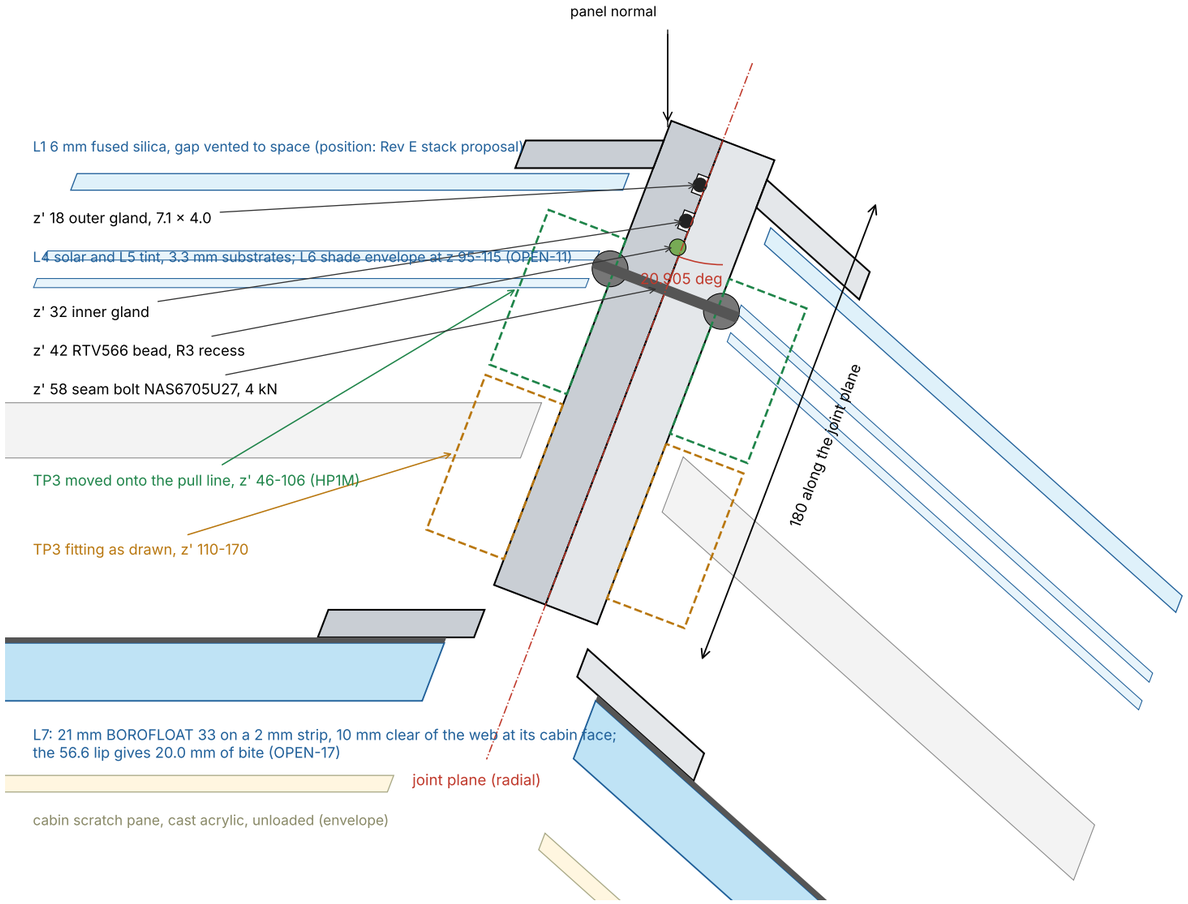
Section normal to a hexagon-to-hexagon seam at the first bolt (271.25 mm from the vertex). Space side at the top. Frame B (left) carries the glands.



Joint-face features, placed along the joint plane (z')

Panel depth = z' x cos(mitre): hexagon 0.9342, pentagon 0.9590. Both frames of a seam share the plane, so holes and glands line up on hexagon-to-pentagon seams too (OPEN-9).

Feature	z'	Hexagon z	Pentagon z
Outer gland	18	16.82	17.26
Leak port	25	23.35	23.97
Inner gland	32	29.89	30.69
RTV recess	42	39.24	40.28
Seam bolt row	58	54.18	55.62
TP3 pads, as drawn	110-170	102.8-158.8	105.5-163.0
TP3 pads, moved (HP1M)	46-106	43.0-99.0	44.1-101.6
Corner tie rows	133.8, 380.0	125.0, 355.0	128.3, 364.4

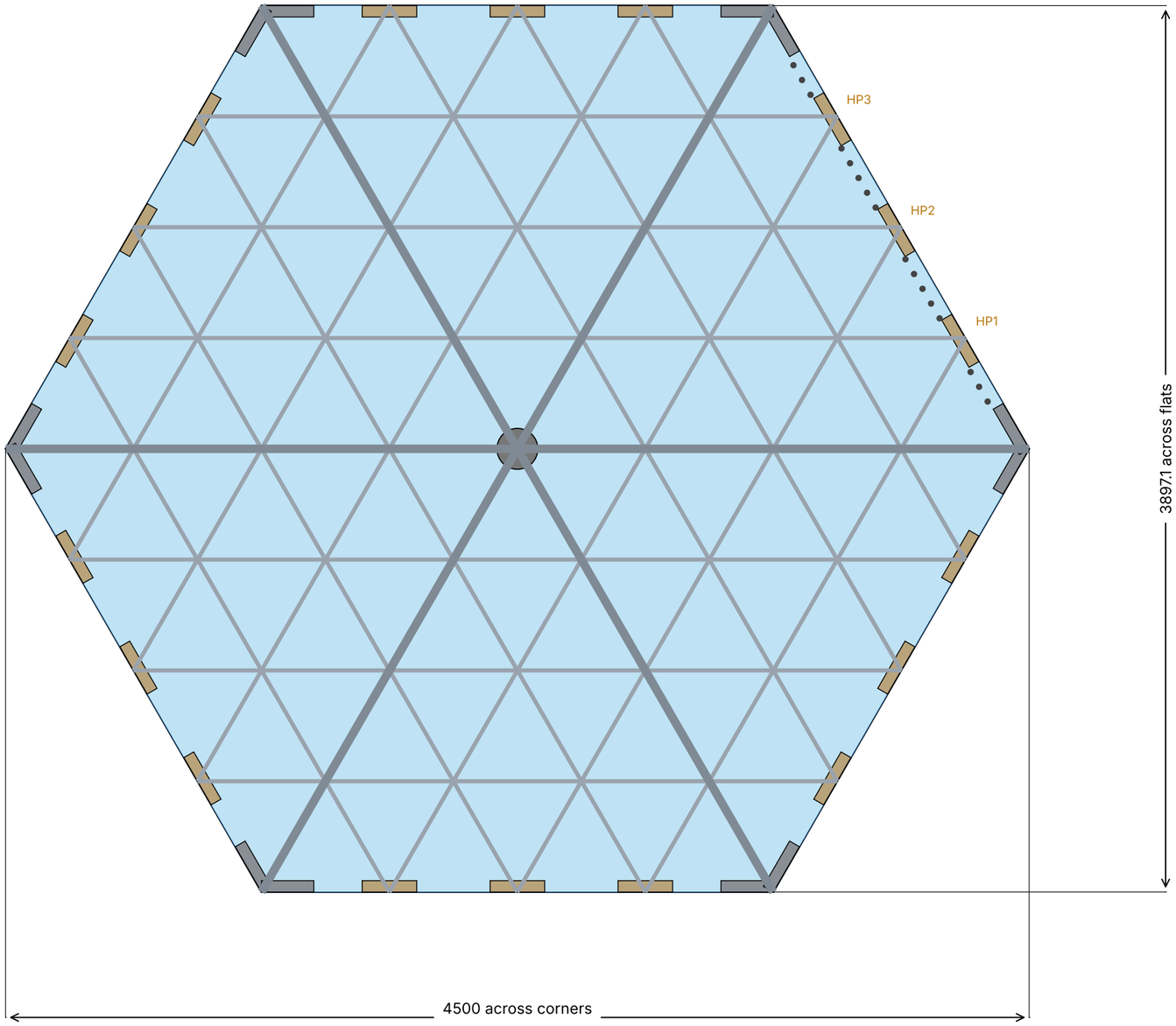
Seal: two loops of Parker BA500 butyl 5.33 mm in 7.1 × 4.0 glands (25 % squeeze, 79 % fill), RTV566 bead cured on the gro
Bolt: NAS6705U27 A286 with KFN670 nut, 4 kN by torque, 16 per seam at 75 pitch in bays of 3, 5, 5, 3.
Loop corners: R16 minimum at the corner block, OPEN (Q92).

What changed from RE-04 (24 Oct): frame 140 to 180; pane 22 to 21 mm; bolt NAS6705U27 at 4 kN (was NAS9306C-06, a rivet standard); the lip and seat moved to the cabin face (z 170-180, P-06) for the restack (Q78); the hardpoint shown in both positions because the fitting as drawn fails the HP1 seal check (0.22 atm free) and the moved fitting holds (0.064 mm at 1.93 atm); Rick decides on 10 Nov. Shear along the seam goes to the hardpoint pins and the vertex dowels, no shear key (OPEN-15, confirmed by FEA 24 Oct). Secondary ribs (I 180 × 60 × 10) and the main rib cap angles (z 375-400) are off this section: see RF-01 and RF-06.

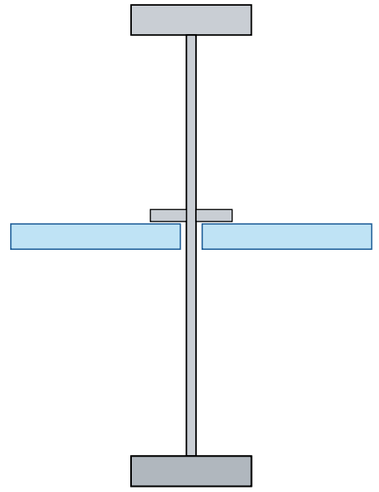
HCSA RF-05 Seam cross-section, hexagon to hexagon, at the first bolt	
Rev F flight design, 8 Nov 2026. Replaces the Rev E draft sheet of 24 Oct	mm. Drawn from the parameters
Status: frame 180, gland, bolt decided 5 Nov; hardpoint position open; outer layers OPEN-11	PROPOSAL where marked
Drawn: Claude for M. Theofanous Checked: - Released: -	Not for machining

Hexagon from the cabin side (schematic, 1:20 on A3): frames, six main ribs, the k 4 secondary grid, hub, corner blocks (grey), hardpoint blocks (gold), 96 panes

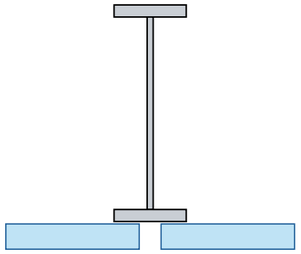
16 seam bolts per edge at 75 pitch in bays of 3, 5, 5, 3 (dots on the upper right edge); the first bolt 271.25 from the vertex; hardpoints HP at 562.5, 1125, 1687.5



Main rib B: I 400 × 100 × 25, web 8
seat ledges at z 170-180, cap angles P-04A at z 375-400



Secondary rib: I 180 × 60 × 10, web 5
pane seat on the cabin face z 180



21 mm panes on 2 mm setting strips, cut 9.09 mm short of the rib centre lines; bite 40.9 (main) and 20.9 (secondary); P-11 brace at every crossing (RF-08 r

k 4 grid: 562.5 mm pitch, 108 secondary rib segments, 96 panes (48 full triangles, 48 cut back at the frame and the hub), 18 six-way nodes, 18 crossings on the main ribs, 18 hardpoints

Parts list, one hexagon (model masses)

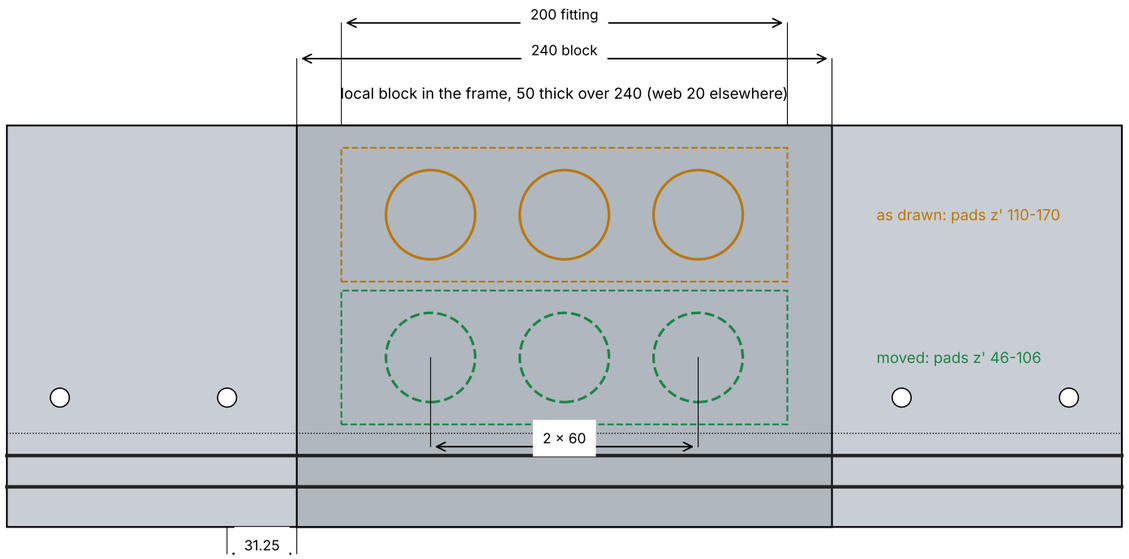
Part	Qty	Each kg	Total kg
P-06 frame member, 180 deep	6	27.86	167
P-04 main rib B	6	33.24	199
P-04A cap angle	12	12.77	153
P-05 hub core	1	28.28	28
P-05A hub star plate	2	14.20	28
P-01 secondary rib segment	108	2.53	273
P-02 node star plate	36	1.75	63
P-03 node web core	18	4.38	79
P-07 pane, 21 mm	96	5.50	528
P-08 pane corner clamp	18	0.19	3
P-14 seam bolt (half of 16 × 6)	48	0.03	1
CB-01 corner block, 2219 forging (parts library, 8 Nov)	6	21.51	129
HP-01 hardpoint block, 6061, in the frame	18	6.41	115
HP-02 fitting half, Ti-6Al-4V	18	1.03	19
HP-03 pin 40 × 160, A286 (3 per hardpoint, shared)	27	1.60	43
P-11 main rib brace pair, 7075	18	1.12	20

Listed parts: 1851 kg per hexagon with its share of the shared pins (shell model 36.1 t for 32 panels; to reconcile).

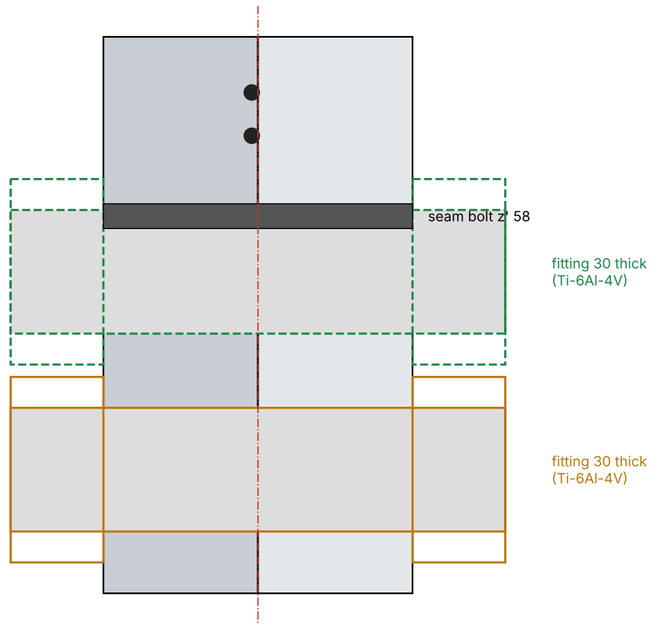
HCSA RF-06 Hexagon panel, general arrangement and parts list

Rev F flight design, 8 Nov 2026. Replaces the Rev E draft sheet of 24 Oct	mm. Drawn from the parameters
Status: ribs and frame decided; blocks, hardpoints, nodes PROPOSAL; model masses	PROPOSAL where marked
Drawn: Claude for M. Theofanous Checked: - Released: -	Not for machining

Joint face at a hardpoint: the 50 mm block, the three 40 mm pin bores at 60 pitch, the two seam bolts beside the fitting (31.25 from its faces)



Section across the seam (space side at the top): pin 40 × 160 through fitting, block, block, fitting



What the models say (HP1, 6-7 Nov). As drawn, the fitting sits 64 mm deeper than the line of the pull (about 76 mm), so the two frames hinge about it and the seals open: the gap between the cords reaches 0.11 mm at 0.22 atm with the frames free to turn and 0.47 atm with them held, against the 1.93 atm required; the two plain bolts beside the fitting carry about 60 kN at 1.96 atm, nearly twice their breaking load, and the frame yields round their holes from about 0.5 atm. With the fitting moved onto the line of the pull (pads 46 to 106), the hardpoint seal gap is 0.064 mm at 1.93 atm and stays under 0.11 mm to 2.5 atm; the plain bolts stay at 13 kN. One place is marginal in the moved case: the seal band at the plain bolt next to the fitting reaches 0.11 mm at 1.87 atm. The fitting in the model is a spring between rigid pads, not pins and bores, so the real part has to be drawn and rerun. The 2 Nov figures of 2.9 to 3.4 atm are withdrawn.

Clash to resolve in the moved position: a 40 mm bore at z' 76 spans z' 56 to 96 and crosses the bolt row at z' 58. Either the two bolts beside the fitting move deeper (about z' 110), or the pins shrink to 32 mm at z' 80 (z' 64-96), or the bolt row near the fitting is dropped and the fitting takes the clamping too. Also open: the fitting's fixing to the aluminium block, the bore chamfers at 1.5 x proof (194-197 MPa against 160, Q18, about 19 % lower at 0.8 atm), galling (dry-film lubricant on the pins), and the seal loops passing the fitting. Fitting stiffness 2.876 million N/mm (C3). Load 108.7 kN per atm on the worst hardpoint.

The three hardpoints on a 2,250 mm seam, from the vertex

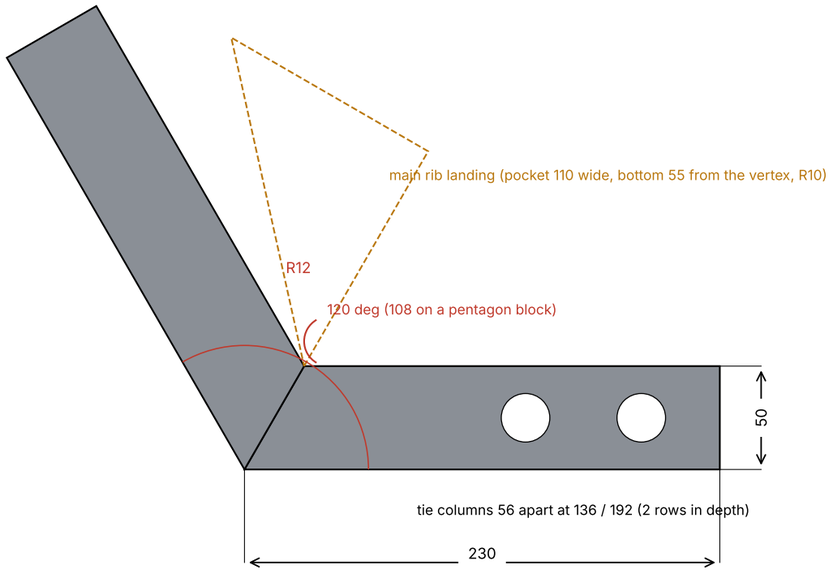
HP1 at 562.5: fitting faces 462.5 and 662.5; nearest bolts 421.25 (41.25 off the outer face) and 693.75 (31.25 off the inner face)

HP2 at 1125.0: fitting faces 1025.0 and 1225.0; nearest bolts 993.75 (41.25 off the outer face) and 1256.25 (31.25 off the inner face)

HP3 at 1687.5: fitting faces 1587.5 and 1787.5; nearest bolts 1556.25 (41.25 off the outer face) and 1818.75 (31.25 off the inner face)

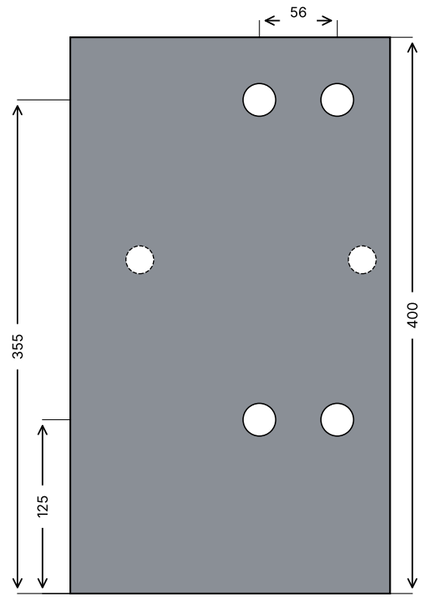
HCSA RF-07 Seam hardpoint: block, TP3 fitting, both positions	
Rev F flight design, 8 Nov 2026. Replaces the Rev E draft sheet of 24 Oct	mm. Drawn from the parameters
Status: PROPOSAL; as drawn fails HP1, moved passes; decision Tue 10 Nov	PROPOSAL where marked
Drawn: Claude for M. Theofanous Checked: - Released: -	Not for machining

Plan of one hexagon corner block (CB-01), looking at the cabin face



joint faces: the legs' outer faces, on the radial joint planes

Joint face of a leg (z' 133.8 and 380 along the plane)



4 ties 7/8-14 Inconel 718 (23.5 holes), 2 dowels 20 (24 room)
hexagon rows z 125 / 355, pentagon rows z 128.3 / 364.4

What the corner model says (C1, 5 Nov)

- Tie preload 198 kN, held to 196.5-198.1 kN, by stretch
- Worst tie at proof, 0.8 atm: 214.5 kN (limit 227)
- Pentagon 15 K warmer: 213.3 kN
- Hatch open, 1 atm: 226.3 kN, 0.7 kN under the limit
- Faces open at proof: 0.55 mm (0.74 at 1 atm), limit 0.8
- Block stress, 95th percentile: 236 MPa (255 at 1 atm), no limit set yet
- Worst corner load 235 kN at 0.8 atm, 290 at 1 atm

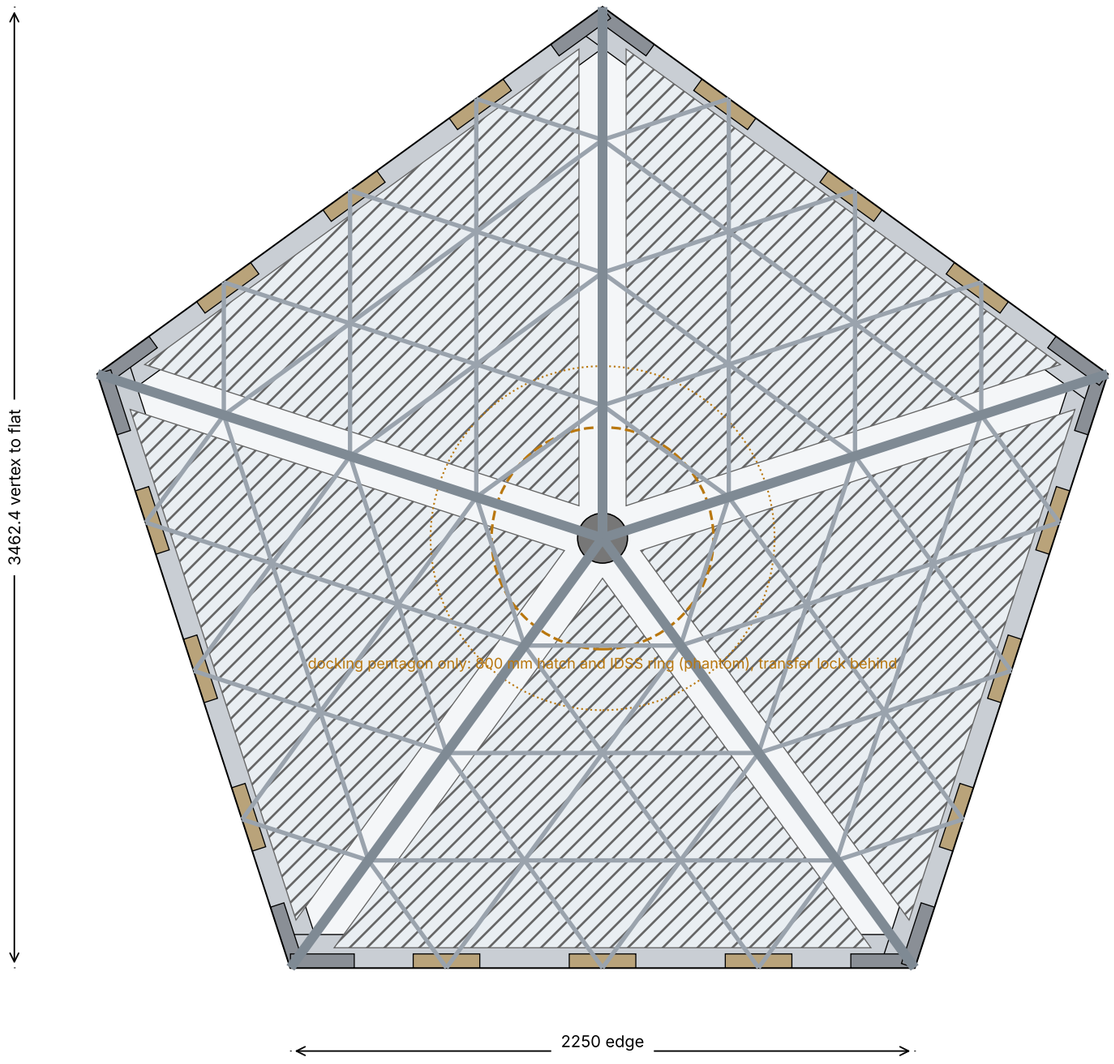
Making it (Marco, 7 Nov). As drawn the node cannot be machined: every inside corner needs a radius an end mill can cut (R10 here, R12 at the re-entrant vertex corner), and the part could be cast instead of machined from a 2219-T852 hand forging (about 300 mm of stock for the 400 mm deep block), which may change the alloy. Both routes are open for Friday. The main rib's flanges enter the block at the vertex landing (notch, PROPOSAL); the two frame members run into the legs' inner faces; the tie-to-web-fillet clash (Q29), the O10 maze-patch corner seal and the loop corners R16 (Q27, Q92) are open. The ties are tightened by measured stretch, because a torque wrench scatters about 25 % and the hatch-open case leaves only 0.7 kN. Forces Marco called 'achievable but unreasonable': 198 kN per tie (about 650-900 N m if torqued), 12 ties per node, 720 on the station. The corner node assembly A-03 (two hexagon blocks and one pentagon block at a real vertex, dihedral 138.19 / 142.62 deg) is in the parts library. Solids of 8 Nov (CB-01 21.5 kg, CB-02 20.7 kg, A-03 76.6 kg): the tie columns moved out to 136 / 192 so the first hole clears the rib landing; the landing bottom is 55 mm from the vertex (60 on the pentagon), leaving 20 / 16 mm of metal to the joint face. The solids are drawn straight; the real joint face leans 20.9 deg (16.5 pentagon) with the seam plane, so three straight blocks overlap at a vertex. Next cut: the leaning face.

Main rib lateral brace (new requirement, 4 Nov): the main rib buckles sideways if unbraced over 2.25 m (0.79 of its load) and has 8.4 times margin braced every 562.5 mm. P-11 (PROPOSAL): a pair of 8 mm 7075 plates on the main rib web from z 180 to z 375 at every secondary rib crossing, bolted through the web, tying the cabin flange to the grid. Size to be checked.

HCSA RF-08 Corner node: blocks, ties, dowels, what the model says, machining

Rev F flight design, 8 Nov 2026. Replaces the Rev E draft sheet of 24 Oct	mm. Drawn from the parameters
Status: PROPOSAL; ties, preload decided; radii per Marco; O10 seal, rib landing open	PROPOSAL where marked
Drawn: Claude for M. Theofanous Checked: - Released: -	Not for machining

Pentagon from the cabin side (schematic, 1:20 on A3): the same frame, main rib and secondary rib parts as the hexagon, no glass, a 10 mm closure plate



k 4 grid: 90 secondary rib segments, 5 main ribs, 5 corner blocks, 15 hardpoints; closure plate 10 mm 6061-T6 as five triangles (hatched), sealed at the main ribs

What the twelve pentagons do

Set by Manos on 25 Oct (PROPOSAL for TRUTH; the model and the earlier TRUTH split still show shield, service, docking and greenhouse pentagons):

- Eleven identical pentagons: inside, a greenhouse alcove and a service panel connected to the central mast; outside, solar panels on standoffs over an insulating blanket, and a stowed inflatable shield that cuts UV, takes heavy MMOD strikes and can act as a repair balloon (Q89).

- One docking pentagon: IDSS ring, 800 mm hatch, the transfer lock and relief valve (RF-04); the hatch stays shut whenever the pressures differ.

- Stabilising thrusters, if ever added, live in the pentagons (Q90). Which way the mast runs is open (Q88).

- The closure plate carries pressure only; a thin stressed skin would see 190 to 680 MPa. At 3.6 m across it is wider than plate comes, so it is five triangles sealed at the main ribs. Which side of the ribs, and how it is held, is OPEN with Marco (Q57). Drawn here on the cabin side at the seat plane, where the glass sits on a hexagon.

- Solar cells must stand off the structure: on bare pentagons in full sun the hexagon-pentagon difference could reach about 100 K (about 380 kN on a corner); on a blanket it is 2 to 15 K (1 Nov model).

- The greenhouses get no daylight: 6 to 9 kW of LED per TRUTH 4; the arrays and batteries for that are not sized.

Pentagon frame: P-06 at 180 deep with the 50 mm lip (pentagons carry no glass). Main ribs P-04 (five), hub P-05 with five arms (variant of th
Corner blocks CB-02 (108 deg, tie rows z 128.3 / 364.4). Hardpoints as RF-07. Mitre 16.472 deg; joint-face features by z' (RF-05 table).
The parts library carries the pentagon assembly A-04 and the closure triangle PL-01 (PROPOSAL, 8 Nov).

HCSA RF-09 Pentagon panel, general arrangement, roles, docking	
Rev F flight design, 8 Nov 2026. Replaces the Rev E draft sheet of 24 Oct	mm. Drawn from the parameters
Status: ribs and frame decided; closure plate side OPEN (Q57); roles PROPOSAL (25 Oct)	PROPOSAL where marked
Drawn: Claude for M. Theofanous Checked: - Released: -	Not for machining